Email Correspondence — Provided by Source

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[Source note: These emails were exported from my university Outlook account. I have redacted my own email address for privacy. Prof. Hargrove's institutional address is included as it is publicly listed on the university website.]

From: m.hargrove@ashworth.ac.uk
To: [REDACTED]
Date: February 18, 2025, 14:22 GMT
Subject: RE: Western blot quantification — final dataset

Elena,

Thanks for sending the updated spreadsheet. I've had a look through the WB quantification for the striatal injection cohort and I think we need to clean up the noise before this goes anywhere near the manuscript. There are several runs that are clearly contaminated — the variance on those bands is well outside what we'd expect from a properly prepared sample. I'd rather we present clean, reproducible data than pad the dataset with runs that will only raise questions in review.

Can you go through and flag anything where the band intensity CV exceeds 15%? We should pull those and re-examine whether they need to be re-run or simply excluded. The reviewers won't care about contaminated runs, but they will care if the error bars are inflated by bad preps.

Let me know when you've done a pass. I'd like to have a clean version by the end of next week.

Best,
Martin

From: [REDACTED]
To: m.hargrove@ashworth.ac.uk
Date: February 20, 2025, 09:47 GMT
Subject: RE: RE: Western blot quantification — final dataset

Prof. Hargrove,

I've gone through the dataset and flagged the runs with CV above 15%. There are nine data points across three experimental groups that meet that criterion. I've highlighted them in yellow in the attached spreadsheet.

However, I wanted to flag that three of these nine points are from Cohort B (the 50mg/kg dose group), and removing all three would shift the mean efficacy for that cohort from 34% to 41%. I want to make sure we're comfortable with that shift before I finalize the exclusion list.

Happy to discuss in person if you'd prefer.

Best,
Elena

From: m.hargrove@ashworth.ac.uk
To: [REDACTED]
Date: February 21, 2025, 11:03 GMT
Subject: RE: RE: RE: Western blot quantification — final dataset

Elena,

Good catch on the Cohort B numbers. The shift is expected — if you're removing bad data, the mean will naturally move toward the true effect. That's not a problem, that's the point. We're not in the business of letting contaminated preps dilute a genuine therapeutic signal.

Go ahead and finalize the exclusion. Make sure you note the exclusion criteria in the methods supplement so it's documented.

M.

From: m.hargrove@ashworth.ac.uk
To: [REDACTED]
Date: March 28, 2025, 16:55 GMT
Subject: Figure 3 — dose-response curve

Elena,

I've been looking at the dose-response figure and I think it needs work before submission. The 25mg/kg group is pulling the curve down in a way that doesn't reflect the overall trend. Those animals had the housing disruption in week 3 — we discussed this at lab meeting — and I think it's defensible to present the dose-response without that group or with a notation.

Can you generate a version of Figure 3 without the 25mg/kg cohort? I want to see how the curve looks. We can decide which version to submit.

Also — the six flagged data points from the WB quantification that we discussed last month. Have those all been removed from the final dataset? I want to make sure the supplementary tables are consistent with the figures.

M.

From: [REDACTED]
To: m.hargrove@ashworth.ac.uk
Date: March 29, 2025, 10:11 GMT
Subject: RE: Figure 3 — dose-response curve

Prof. Hargrove,

I've generated the alternative version of Figure 3 without the 25mg/kg group. It's attached. The curve is substantially smoother and the R-squared improves from 0.71 to 0.93.

Regarding the WB data points — yes, those are excluded in the current dataset.

One concern: removing an entire dose group from a dose-response curve is unusual and may attract reviewer scrutiny. The housing disruption is documented in the animal facility logs, but I'm not sure it's sufficient justification for excluding a full cohort from the primary figure. Would you be open to keeping the group in and adding an explanatory footnote instead?

Elena

From: m.hargrove@ashworth.ac.uk
To: [REDACTED]
Date: March 29, 2025, 17:40 GMT
Subject: RE: RE: Figure 3 — dose-response curve

Elena,

Let’s go with the version without the 25mg/kg group. The housing disruption is a legitimate confound and the reviewers will understand. If they push back, we can always add it back with the footnote in revision. But I’d rather start with a clean story and negotiate from there than lead with a messy figure.

The R-squared speaks for itself.

Please finalize Figure 3 and update the results section accordingly. I’d like to submit by April 15.

M.

From: [REDACTED]
To: m.hargrove@ashworth.ac.uk
Date: April 14, 2025, 08:33 GMT
Subject: Concerns about dataset

Prof. Hargrove,

I wanted to raise something that’s been on my mind. As I was finalizing the supplementary materials over the weekend, I went back to the raw data files for the behavioral assay (rotarod performance, Figure 4). The values in the current manuscript draft for the high-dose group don’t match what I have in my original analysis files. Specifically, the published mean for the 100mg/kg rotarod improvement is listed as 47.3%, but my raw analysis shows 38.1%.

I want to make sure I haven’t made an error somewhere, but I’ve checked my files twice and I’m confident in the raw numbers. Could we sit down and reconcile this before submission?

Elena

From: m.hargrove@ashworth.ac.uk
To: [REDACTED]
Date: April 14, 2025, 15:12 GMT
Subject: RE: Concerns about dataset

Elena,

I updated Figure 4 myself last week using the corrected baseline normalization that we discussed at the March 20 lab meeting. The difference you’re seeing is the baseline adjustment — I used the pre-treatment day -3 values rather than the day -1 values, which is more standard in the field and gives a cleaner comparison.

I should have flagged the change to you. Let me know if you want to walk through it, but I’m confident the current version is correct.

M.